Nursing Styles

Caregiver Recruiting and Screening Kit

A shared, consistent way to find, screen, and welcome great Care Partners and nurses for our Pinellas, Pasco, Manatee, and Sarasota clients.

Purpose

Our careers page says it plainly: we are not looking for just anyone, we want the best. This kit turns that promise into a repeatable process so every applicant gets the same fair questions, the same scoring, and a quick, friendly response, whether they apply to the Largo office or the Sarasota office.

It covers who we can hire for each role under Florida rules, a standard phone screen, a scoring rubric with knockout criteria, how interviews get onto management calendars, and ready-to-use messages for every step. A companion workbook, Applicant Screening Scorecard.xlsx, holds the same questions with automatic score totals.

At a glance

Step	Who	Target timing	Tool
1. Application received	Applicant	Any time	AxisCare caregiver application
2. Review and send acknowledgment	Recruiting coordinator	Within 1 business day	AxisCare applicant record, Template A
3. Phone screen (15 to 20 minutes)	Recruiting coordinator	Within 2 business days of review	Scorecard, Template B
4. Score and decide	Recruiting coordinator	Same day as screen	Scorecard rubric
5. Interview with management	Office administrator or Director of Nursing	Within 3 business days of screen	Management calendar, Templates C and D
6. Conditional offer	Management	Within 2 business days of interview	Offer letter
7. Clearance and onboarding	Office team	Before the first client visit	Level 2 screening, documents, orientation

1. Who we hire and what we offer

Nursing Styles has served Florida families since 1997 as a locally owned, non-franchise agency. Every Care Partner is an employee, not an independent contractor. Care runs from 4 hours a day to 24/7, which means we recruit for days, evenings, overnights, weekends, and live-in style coverage.

Services our team delivers

Service line	What it includes	Typical role
Home care	Companionship, meal preparation, light housekeeping, errands and transportation, activities of daily living, bathing, dressing, toileting	Companion or homemaker, Home Health Aide, CNA
Skilled nursing	Medication management and administration, wound care and dressing changes, catheter, ostomy and tube feeding care, IV therapy and injections, chronic disease management, pain and symptom management, post surgical recovery	LPN, RN

Service line	What it includes	Typical role
Specialized care	Alzheimer's and dementia care, Parkinson's, stroke recovery, end of life and palliative support, care coordination	HHA, CNA, LPN, RN
Veteran care	In-home support for veterans, VA Community Care Network partnership, HISA grant support	All roles
Home modifications	Safety assessments and changes for aging in place	Office and clinical leadership

What we tell applicants about working here

From our careers page: honesty, dignity, and respect; competitive pay with incentives; referral bonuses; paid training; and a flexible schedule built around the Care Partner's request. Care Partners work with seniors as active partners in their own wellbeing. Use this language in job posts and on calls so the message stays consistent.

Where applicants apply

The careers page links to our AxisCare caregiver application (6310.axiscare.com). Every applicant should end up as an AxisCare applicant record, even if they first reach us by phone, walk-in, Indeed, or referral, so nothing lives only in an inbox or on a sticky note.

2. Minimum qualifications by role

These are the floors we hold for every hire. Items marked as Florida rule come from the statutes and rules in the References table. Items marked as agency standard come from our own careers page and can be adjusted by management. All roles share the core requirements in the first table; role specific requirements follow.

Core requirements for every direct care role

Requirement	Source	How we confirm it	When
Level 2 background screening (fingerprints, state and national) cleared through the AHCA Care Provider Background Screening Clearinghouse, or an exemption granted	Florida rule: s. 400.512, s. 408.809, ch. 435 F.S.	Livescan fingerprinting; check eligibility in the Clearinghouse and add the employee to our roster; signed attestation of compliance (s. 435.05)	After conditional offer, before any client contact
Authorized to work in the United States	Federal law (Form I-9); Florida s. 448.095 adds E-Verify for private employers with 25 or more employees	Form I-9 completed by the end of the third business day of work; E-Verify case if we are covered	First day of work (never before an offer)
Current CPR and first aid	Agency standard for all roles; Florida rule for HHAs and CNAs (59A-8.0095(5)(k))	Copy of card from American Heart Association, American Red Cross, National Safety Council, or a CAPCE accredited provider, with an in-person skills check	Before first shift
Current physical and TB screening	Agency standard; CDC recommends baseline TB screening for all health care personnel at hire	Physician or clinic statement; TB blood test (IGRA) or two-step skin test	After conditional offer only
Valid driver's license and a reliable vehicle with air conditioning	Agency standard; Florida s. 322.03 for any driving	View license; note expiration	Phone screen (ask), interview (view)
Valid auto insurance	Agency standard; Florida	Copy of insurance card in the	Interview or

Requirement	Source	How we confirm it	When
	requires at least $10,000 PIP and $10,000 property damage liability (s. 627.736, s. 324.022)	applicant's name or as a listed driver	onboarding
Dementia training	Florida rule: s. 430.5025 (applies to home health agencies)	Written dementia information on day one; 1 hour state training within 30 days for anyone giving personal care or having regular client contact; keep completion record	Onboarding
Preferred: high school diploma or equivalent	Agency standard (desired, not required)	Ask on application	Application

Role specific requirements

Role	What they do	Must have	Nice to have
Companion or Homemaker Care Partner	Companionship, supervision, meal prep, light housekeeping, laundry, errands, transportation, reminders. No hands-on personal care (Florida defines companion and homemaker services as excluding it).	Core requirements above Comfortable driving clients and running errands Willing to learn our dementia approach	Prior caregiving, including family caregiving Interest in completing HHA training (we offer paid training)
Home Health Aide (HHA)	Hands-on personal care: bathing, dressing, grooming, toileting, transfers, ambulation, feeding assistance, vital signs, assisting with self-administered medication, under RN supervision.	Core requirements above Documented completion of at least 40 hours of HHA training (or passing the AHCA HHA competency test) before giving care, with skills shown in person (59A-8.0095(5)(c)) Out of state aides: transcript or certificate showing hours and curriculum Annual in-service training	Hoyer lift and gait belt experience Dementia experience If we bill Medicare or Medicaid home health, federal rules require 75 hours of training plus a competency evaluation (42 CFR 484.80)
Certified Nursing Assistant (CNA)	Same personal care duties as an HHA, often with more complex clients.	Core requirements above Active Florida CNA certification through the Board of Nursing (s. 464.203), verified on the Department of Health license lookup CPR as required by 59A-8.0095(5)(k) Annual in-service training	One or more years in home care, assisted living, or skilled nursing Hoyer lift, incontinence, and end of life care experience
Licensed Practical Nurse (LPN)	Skilled visits and shifts under RN direction: medication administration, wound care, catheter and ostomy care, tube feeding, monitoring.	Core requirements above Active Florida LPN license or multistate compact license (s. 464.008, s. 464.0095), verified on the license lookup with no restrictions Current CPR (BLS preferred)	IV certification (for IV therapy clients) One or more years of nursing experience, home health preferred
Registered Nurse (RN)	Assessments, care planning, supervision of aides and CNAs, IV therapy and injections, complex wound care, care coordination.	Core requirements above Active Florida RN license or multistate compact license, verified with no restrictions Current BLS	Home health experience (HHA trainers must be RNs with 2 years of nursing experience, 1 in home health) IV, PICC, and wound care skills

A note on the careers page. It currently says CNA or HHA certification is a plus, not required. That is accurate for companion and homemaker work. For anyone assigned hands-on personal care, the HHA

training or CNA certification above must be on file before the first personal care visit. Applicants without it can be hired as companions and moved into our paid HHA training.

License and exclusion checks. For every CNA, LPN, and RN, print or save the Department of Health license verification. Because we serve veterans through the VA network, also check each new hire against the HHS OIG exclusion list before hire and keep the result in the file.

3. Standard phone screening questions

Ask every applicant the same questions, in the same order, and score as you go. The call takes 15 to 20 minutes. Open warmly: thank them for applying, share who we are in two sentences, and tell them the call will cover their experience, schedule, and travel area, with time for their questions.

Suggested opening. "Hi [First Name], this is [Your Name] with Nursing Styles. Thank you for applying to be a Care Partner. Is now still a good time? I have about 15 minutes of questions about your experience, availability, and the areas you like to work, and then I'd love to answer any questions you have."

#	Topic	Ask	What a good answer looks like	Weight
1	Position and motivation	Which position are you most interested in, and what draws you to home care?	Names a role; talks about caring for people, purpose, or a personal experience; shows they understand home care is one-on-one in a client's home.	2
2	Experience	Tell me about your caregiving experience. Where, how long, and what kinds of clients?	Specific settings, length of time, and client types (seniors, dementia, post hospital). Family caregiving counts for companion roles.	2
3	Certifications	Which certifications or licenses do you hold right now? (CNA, HHA training certificate, LPN, RN, CPR, first aid.) When do they expire?	Can name each credential and expiration date. For HHA, CNA, and nurse roles, holds the required credential or a clear plan; CPR current or willing to get it before starting.	2
4	Background screening	This role requires a Level 2 fingerprint background screening through Florida's AHCA Clearinghouse. Are you willing to complete it? Have you been fingerprinted for a Florida health care employer in the past five years?	Yes, without hesitation. Prior Clearinghouse screening is a plus (may speed clearance). Do not ask about arrests.	Knockout
5	Work authorization	Are you legally authorized to work in the United States? Will you now or in the future need sponsorship for employment visa status?	Yes to authorization. Ask only these two questions; do not ask about citizenship, birthplace, or immigration status.	Knockout
6	Availability by day	Which days of the week are you available to work?	Clear days listed. More days, and any weekend days, score higher.	2
7	Availability by shift	Which shifts work for you: mornings, afternoons, evenings, overnights, 12 hour shifts, 24 hour or live-in, weekends, holidays?	Clear shifts listed. Nights, weekends, and holidays are our hardest to fill and score highest.	2
8	Hours	About how many hours a week would you like to work?	A number or range that fits our open cases; flexible is a plus.	1
9	Transportation	Do you have a valid Florida driver's license, a reliable vehicle with air conditioning, and auto insurance? Are you comfortable driving clients to appointments and errands?	Yes to all; comfortable driving clients. Out of state license with a plan to transfer is a Hold.	Knockout
10	Preferred areas	Which counties or areas do you prefer to work in (Pinellas, Pasco, Manatee, Sarasota), and how far are you willing to drive to a client?	Names counties near our open cases; willing to drive 20 to 30 minutes or more.	2
11	Dementia care	Tell me about a time you cared for someone with memory loss. What would you do if a client with dementia became upset and insisted on leaving the house?	Stays calm, reassures, redirects, keeps the client safe, does not argue, calls the office. Experience is a plus; a thoughtful answer counts.	2
12	Personal care	How comfortable are you with personal care such as bathing, dressing, toileting, and incontinence care? (HHA, CNA, nurse roles.)	Comfortable and respectful; mentions privacy and dignity. For companions, understands the boundary.	2

#	Topic	Ask	What a good answer looks like	Weight
		For companion roles: this role does not include hands-on care; is that a fit for you?		
13	Lifting and transfers	Our clients often need help moving, including transfers from bed to chair with a gait belt, and sometimes a Hoyer lift. Can you perform these tasks, with or without a reasonable accommodation? Have you used a Hoyer lift?	Yes; describes safe technique (body mechanics, asks for help, uses equipment). Never ask about medical conditions or why they might not be able to.	2
14	Pets and smoking	Some client homes have dogs, cats, or other pets, and some have smokers. Are you comfortable working in homes with pets? With smoking in the home?	Honest answer. This is for matching, not scoring against them. Note any homes to avoid.	Info
15	Languages	Our clients speak a variety of languages. Besides English, do you speak, read, or write any other languages fluently?	Any fluent language is a plus for matching. Ask only about languages spoken, never about national origin.	1
16	Reliability scenario	You're on your way to a client and realize you'll be 20 minutes late. What do you do?	Calls the office right away (not just the client), gives an arrival time, and follows our call-out process. Shows ownership.	2
17	Safety scenario	Your client falls while you are helping them to the bathroom. Walk me through what you do.	Does not lift an injured client alone; checks for injury; calls 911 if hurt or unsure; calls the office; documents. Stays with the client.	2
18	Start date	If we move forward, when could you start? Do you need to give notice anywhere?	Can start within 1 to 2 weeks, or a clear date.	1
19	Pay expectations	What hourly pay are you looking for?	Within the range management sets for the role. Out of range is a conversation, not a knockout.	1
20	References	Can you provide two references, ideally supervisors from caregiving or other jobs?	Yes, with supervisors named.	1
21	Their questions	What questions do you have for us?	Asks about clients, schedule, training, or the team. Shows genuine interest.	1

Add-on questions for nurse applicants (LPN and RN)

#	Ask	What a good answer looks like
N1	Please share your Florida or compact license number so we can verify it. Any restrictions?	Active license, no restrictions, verifiable on the license lookup.
N2	Which of these skills are you current in: IV therapy and PICC care, injections, wound care and dressing changes, catheter and ostomy care, tube feeding?	Specific, recent examples; honest about what needs a refresher.
N3	How do you handle a change in a patient's condition when you're the only clinician in the home?	Assesses, intervenes within scope, calls the physician and the Director of Nursing, documents clearly.
N4	(RN) Have you supervised aides or CNAs, or completed home health assessments and care plans?	Yes, with examples; understands supervisory visits and documentation.

Closing the call. Thank them, explain next steps and timing ("You'll hear from us by [day]"), and confirm the best phone number and email, and whether it is okay to text them. Enter scores and notes in the Scorecard the same day.

4. Scoring rubric

Knockout criteria

A knockout means the applicant cannot move forward for that role right now. Apply knockouts the same way for everyone, and record the reason in AxisCare.

Knockout	Applies to	What to do instead
Not willing to complete Level 2 background screening	All roles	Close the application kindly (Template E).
Not legally authorized to work in the United States	All roles	Close the application (Template E). Do not ask for documents before an offer.
No valid driver's license, reliable vehicle, or auto insurance	All roles, unless management approves an exception (see Open Questions)	Hold if a license or insurance is in process; otherwise close.
No required credential and no plan to get it	HHA (40 hour training), CNA (active certification), LPN and RN (active license)	Offer the companion role or our paid HHA training if a fit.
Unwilling to provide hands-on personal care	HHA and CNA roles	Offer the companion or homemaker role.
Availability does not match any open need, and applicant is not flexible	All roles	Hold in AxisCare for future openings rather than declining.
Disqualifying result in Level 2 screening with no exemption granted	All roles (discovered after offer)	Withdraw the offer in writing; the applicant may apply to AHCA for an exemption (s. 435.07).

Score scale

Score each weighted question from 0 to 3, then multiply by its weight. The Scorecard does the math automatically.

Score	Meaning	Example (Question 11, dementia care)
3	Strong: specific, confident, matches what we need	Describes redirecting a client with dementia, staying calm, and calling the office, with a real example.
2	Solid: reasonable answer with some detail	Has not worked with dementia but describes a calm, safe approach.
1	Limited: vague or minimal fit	"I'd just tell them to sit down."
0	Concern: wrong, unsafe, or no answer	Would argue with the client or restrain them.

Decision bands

Weighted score (out of 84)	Percent	Decision	Next step
63 and above	75% or more	Advance	Invite to interview within 3 business days (Template C).
46 to 62	55% to 74%	Hold or second look	Coordinator and office administrator review together within 1 business day; advance if the applicant fills a hard to staff need (nights, weekends, a specific county or language).
45 and below	Under 55%	Do not advance	Send Template E within 5 business days.
Any knockout	Any	Do not advance for this role	See the knockout table above.

The maximum is 84 points: 11 questions with a weight of 2 and 6 questions with a weight of 1, each scored up to 3. Knockout and information questions are not scored. Bands are a starting point; adjust them after the first month of use.

5. Interview scheduling with management

Who interviews

Applicant	Pinellas and Pasco	Sarasota and Manatee
Companion, HHA, CNA	Shaun Carroll, Owner, CEO and Administrator, or delegate	Susan Vowels, RN, Administrator, or delegate
LPN, RN	Shaun Carroll with clinical leadership	Michelle La Scala, RN, Director of Nursing

Process

1. **Hold recruiting blocks.** Each interviewer keeps two or three standing 30 minute interview blocks a week on their calendar (for example, Tuesday and Thursday mornings). The coordinator books into these blocks without needing to ask first.
2. **Offer two or three times.** After an Advance decision, the coordinator offers two or three open block times by phone or text, and confirms the format: in person at the Largo office (2401 West Bay Dr, Suite 124) or the Sarasota office (5602 Marquesas Cir, Suite 201), or video for a first conversation.
3. **Book it.** Create a calendar invite for the interviewer titled “Interview: [Applicant Name], [Role], [Office]”. Paste in the scorecard total, top strengths, open questions, availability, and preferred counties so the interviewer is ready in two minutes.
4. **Update AxisCare.** Move the applicant to the interview scheduled status and log the date and time.
5. **Confirm and remind.** Send Template C right away and Template D the day before. If the applicant does not confirm, call once the morning of the interview.
6. **Ask them to bring.** Driver’s license, auto insurance card, CPR card, and any CNA, HHA, or nursing credential, so we can confirm role requirements. Do not ask for I-9 documents, a physical, or TB results until after an offer.
7. **Interview.** Use the same core interview questions for each role, plus a short skills conversation. Interviewers score on the Interview tab of the Scorecard.
8. **Decide within 2 business days.** The interviewer records Hire, Hold, or Decline in AxisCare. The coordinator sends the conditional offer or the not moving forward message.
9. **No-shows.** One reschedule is offered. After a second no-show, close the application with Template E.

How the kit fits AxisCare

- **One home for every applicant.** Everyone who applies through the careers page lands in AxisCare’s applicant area. Phone, walk-in, and referral applicants are entered there too.
- **Statuses that match this kit.** Suggested applicant statuses: New, Acknowledged, Screen Scheduled, Screened (Advance, Hold, Do Not Advance), Interview Scheduled, Interviewed, Conditional Offer, Clearance in Progress, Hired, Closed. Status changes in AxisCare are manual, so update them at each step.
- **Screening notes.** Record the total score, decision band, and any knockout reason in the applicant notes, and attach the completed Scorecard tab if attachments are enabled.
- **Application questions.** The application form can ask the same knockout questions up front (willing to complete Level 2, authorized to work, license and vehicle, county preferences, shifts), which saves calls.

- **Matching after hire.** When an applicant becomes a caregiver, carry over availability, counties, languages, pets and smoking comfort, and skills such as Hoyer lift and dementia care, since AxisCare matches caregivers to clients by these attributes.
- **Credentials.** Track CPR, license, TB, and training expiration dates on the caregiver record once hired.

6. Applicant follow-up message templates

Replace anything in [brackets]. Email versions are full messages; text versions are short enough for one SMS. Text only applicants who agreed to receive texts on the application or by phone, and include opt-out wording in the first text.

A. Application received

Email

Subject: Thank you for applying to Nursing Styles

Hi [First Name],

Thank you for applying for the [Role] position with Nursing Styles. We're glad you're interested in joining our team of Care Partners.

Our recruiting team reviews every application personally. If your experience and availability match our current needs, we'll reach out within [2] business days to set up a short phone call.

If you have any questions in the meantime, call our [Office] office at [Office Phone].

Warmly,
[Your Name]
Nursing Styles, [Office] Office

Text message

Hi [First Name], this is [Your Name] at Nursing Styles. Thanks for applying for our [Role] position! We'll be in touch within [2] business days. Reply STOP to opt out of texts.

B. Phone screening invite

Email

Subject: Let's set up a quick call, Nursing Styles

Hi [First Name],

Thanks again for applying for the [Role] position. We'd love to learn more about you in a short phone call of about 15 to 20 minutes.

Here are a few times that work on our end:
• [Day, Date, Time]
• [Day, Date, Time]
• [Day, Date, Time]

Just reply with the time that suits you best, or call me at [Office Phone] if another time is easier. We'll talk about your experience, the days and shifts you prefer, and the areas you like to work.

Looking forward to talking,
[Your Name]
Nursing Styles, [Office] Office

Text message

Hi [First Name], [Your Name] from Nursing Styles. Can we do a 15 minute call about the [Role] job? Are [Time 1] or [Time 2] good for you? Reply with a time or call [Office Phone].

C. Interview invite

Email

Subject: Interview invitation, Nursing Styles

Hi [First Name],

It was great speaking with you. We'd like to invite you to interview for the [Role] position.

Date and time: [Day, Date, Time]
With: [Interviewer Name, Title]
Where: [Office Address] or [Video Link]
Length: about 30 minutes

Please bring your driver's license, auto insurance card, CPR card, and any CNA, HHA, or nursing credential you hold.

Please reply to confirm, or call [Office Phone] if you need a different time.

See you soon,
[Your Name]
Nursing Styles, [Office] Office

Text message

Hi [First Name], you're invited to interview for [Role] on [Day, Date] at [Time] at [Office Address]. Bring your license, insurance card, and CPR card. Reply YES to confirm.

D. Interview reminder

Email

Subject: Reminder: your Nursing Styles interview tomorrow

Hi [First Name],

Just a friendly reminder of your interview tomorrow, [Day, Date], at [Time] with [Interviewer Name].

Where: [Office Address] [Parking or suite notes] or [Video Link]
Please bring: driver's license, auto insurance card, CPR card, and any credentials.

If something has come up, please call [Office Phone] so we can find another time.

We look forward to meeting you,
[Your Name]

Nursing Styles, [Office] Office

Text message

Reminder: your Nursing Styles interview is tomorrow, [Date] at [Time], at [Office Address]. Need to reschedule? Call [Office Phone]. See you then!

E. Not moving forward

Email

Subject: Your application with Nursing Styles

Hi [First Name],

Thank you for your interest in Nursing Styles and for the time you spent with us. After careful review, we will not be moving forward with your application for the [Role] position at this time.

This decision may reflect our current scheduling and area needs, and we appreciate the care you bring to this work. You are welcome to apply again in the future.

We wish you all the best,
[Your Name]
Nursing Styles, [Office] Office

Text message

Hi [First Name], thank you for applying with Nursing Styles. We won't be moving forward with the [Role] position right now, but you're welcome to apply again. Best wishes!

F. Missing documents

Email

Subject: A few items needed to finish your file

Hi [First Name],

You're almost there! To finish your file for the [Role] position, we still need:

[Document List, for example: copy of CPR card, HHA training certificate, proof of auto insurance]

You can [upload them to your application / email them to [Email] / bring them to the [Office] office]. Please send them by [Deadline] so we can keep things moving.

Questions? Call me at [Office Phone].

Thank you,
[Your Name]
Nursing Styles, [Office] Office

Text message

Hi [First Name], Nursing Styles here. We still need [Document] to finish your file. Can you send it by [Deadline]? Questions: [Office Phone].

Adverse action note. If an applicant is declined because of a report from an outside background or driving record company, the federal Fair Credit Reporting Act requires a pre-adverse action notice with a copy of the report, then a final adverse action notice. Use Template E only for decisions not based on such a report.

7. Keeping questions legal

Ask only about the job: skills, credentials, schedule, travel, and the tasks the role requires. Federal law (enforced by the EEOC) and the Florida Civil Rights Act protect applicants from decisions based on who they are. Pinellas County's human rights ordinance adds protections such as sexual orientation and gender identity. When in doubt, leave it out.

Do not ask about	Instead, you may ask
Age, date of birth, graduation years	"Are you at least 18?" only if management sets 18 as a minimum age
Race, color, national origin, ancestry, birthplace, accent, citizenship	"Are you legally authorized to work in the U.S.?" and the sponsorship question; which languages they speak fluently
Religion, church, religious holidays	"Which days and shifts are you available?"
Marital status, children, pregnancy, childcare, family plans, spouse's job	The same availability and reliability questions for everyone
Disability, health conditions, medications, prior injuries, workers' compensation claims, allergies	"Can you perform [specific task], with or without reasonable accommodation?" Physicals and TB tests come only after a conditional offer
Genetic information or family medical history	Nothing; do not ask
Sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, height, weight	Lifting and transfer tasks the job requires
Arrest records	Willingness to complete Level 2 screening; the AHCA process applies Florida's disqualifying offense list
Military discharge type	Relevant skills or training from military service
Credit history, home ownership, bank accounts	Nothing; not related to caregiving

If an applicant volunteers personal information (for example, "I have three kids"), do not write it down or follow up. Steer back to the job: "Thanks for sharing. Which shifts work best for you?"

8. Assumptions

- Both offices hold Florida home health agency licenses with AHCA (Largo license 299994364 and Sarasota license 299991122, as shown on our website), so the home health agency rules in Chapter 400, Part III and Rule 59A-8 apply.
- We operate as a state licensed home health agency and do not bill Medicare home health, so the 40 hour Florida HHA training standard applies rather than the 75 hour federal standard.
- A recruiting coordinator or office staff member handles screening calls, and the administrators and Director of Nursing interview, based on the roles listed on our About page.
- Nurses (LPN and RN) are hired for skilled nursing services, even though the careers page focuses on Care Partners.
- Applicants may not start client work until Level 2 screening is cleared in the Clearinghouse.
- Weights, score bands, and timing targets in this kit are starting points to be tuned after a month of use.

9. Open questions for Shaun

- **Pay ranges.** What hourly ranges should we share for companion, HHA, CNA, LPN, and RN roles, and are there differentials for nights, weekends, holidays, live-in, or 24 hour cases? What are the referral bonus amounts and incentive details?
- **Paid training.** Do we run the 40 hour HHA training in house, and who is the RN trainer? Can companions be hired and then moved into HHA training, and is it paid at the full rate?
- **Medicare status.** Do either office bill Medicare or Medicaid home health? If so, HHA training and competency rules are stricter.
- **Nurse hiring.** Are we actively hiring LPNs and RNs, per visit or per shift, and should IV certification be required or preferred?
- **Driving exceptions.** Is a car, license, and insurance an absolute requirement, or can someone who uses other reliable transportation work non-driving cases? Do we require a minimum auto liability limit above Florida's minimum, or a driving record check?
- **Minimum age and experience.** Do we set a minimum age (for example 18) or a minimum months of experience for any role?
- **Who interviews.** Confirm interviewers for each office and role, the standing interview blocks, and whether first interviews can be by video.
- **Level 2 costs and timing.** Does the agency pay fingerprinting fees, and may anyone begin paid orientation (not client contact) while screening is pending?
- **Physical and TB.** Which clinic do we use, who pays, and do we accept a TB blood test, two-step skin test, or both?
- **E-Verify.** Do we have 25 or more employees, so that Florida's E-Verify requirement applies, and are we enrolled?
- **AxisCare setup.** Which applicant statuses and custom application questions are already configured, who has access, and are we using any recruiting add-on (such as Indeed, Hireology, or Augusta) that feeds AxisCare?
- **Texting.** Is texting applicants from AxisCare or the office phone allowed, and do we capture text consent on the application?
- **Background vendor.** Do we use an outside company for driving records, references, or extra background checks? If so, we need its FCRA disclosure and adverse action forms.
- **Hiring policies.** Any agency rules on rehiring former employees, hiring family members of clients, overtime limits, or probation periods that should be written into this kit?

10. References

Topic	Source	Link
Level 2 screening for home health, companion, and homemaker staff	s. 400.512, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/400.512
Who must be screened and how (AHCA licensing)	s. 408.809, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/408.809
Level 2 screening standards and disqualifying offenses	s. 435.04, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/435.04
Employee attestation of compliance	s. 435.05, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/435.05
Exemptions from disqualification	s. 435.07, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/435.07
Care Provider Background Screening	s. 435.12, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/435.12

Topic	Source	Link
Clearinghouse		
AHCA Clearinghouse portal and instructions	AHCA Background Screening	https://info.flclearinghouse.com/
Definitions of home health aide, CNA, companion and homemaker services	s. 400.462, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/400.462
Home health agency personnel: HHA 40 hour training, CPR, in-service	Rule 59A-8.0095, Florida Administrative Code	https://www.flrules.org/gateway/ruleNo.asp?id=59A-8.0095
AHCA guidance on home health aide training or testing	AHCA Home Health Aides	https://ahca.myflorida.com/health-quality-assurance/bureau-of-health-facility-regulation/laboratory-and-in-home-services/home-health-agencies/home-health-aides.html
Federal home health aide training (Medicare agencies)	42 CFR 484.80	https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-42/chapter-IV/subchapter-G/part-484/subpart-B/section-484.80
Alzheimer's and dementia training for home health staff	s. 400.4785 and s. 430.5025, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/430.5025
CNA certification	s. 464.203, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/464.203
Florida Board of Nursing	Florida Department of Health	https://floridasnursing.gov/
License verification for CNAs, LPNs, and RNs	Florida DOH License Verification	https://mqa-internet.doh.state.fl.us/MQASearchServices/HealthCareProviders
RN and LPN licensure	s. 464.008, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/464.008
Nurse Licensure Compact (multistate licenses)	s. 464.0095, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/464.0095
Driver license required to drive	s. 322.03, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/322.03
Personal injury protection minimum	s. 627.736, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/627.736
Property damage liability minimum	s. 324.022, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/324.022
TB screening for health care personnel at hire	CDC	https://www.cdc.gov/tb-healthcare-settings/hcp/screening-testing/baseline-testing.html
Employment eligibility verification	Form I-9, USCIS	https://www.uscis.gov/i-9
Florida employment eligibility and E-Verify	s. 448.095, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/448.095
E-Verify program	E-Verify	https://www.e-verify.gov/
Prohibited employment policies and practices	EEOC	https://www.eeoc.gov/prohibited-employment-policiespractices
Disability related questions before an offer	EEOC ADA guidance	https://www.eeoc.gov/laws/guidance/enforcement-guidance-preemployment-disability-related-questions-and-medical
Arrest and conviction records	EEOC	https://www.eeoc.gov/arrestandconviction
Florida Civil Rights Act, unlawful employment practices	s. 760.10, Florida Statutes	https://www.flsenate.gov/Laws/Statutes/2026/760.10
Florida Commission on Human Relations	FCHR	https://fchr.myflorida.com/
Background checks and consumer reports	FTC	https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/background-checks-what-employers-need-know
Exclusion list check	HHS Office of Inspector General LEIE	https://oig.hhs.gov/exclusions/
Nursing Styles careers page and AxisCare application	Nursing Styles	https://nursingstylesfl.com/careers/